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Solenoid/magnetic hold brake with power off magnet hold function

Abstract

A power drive unit (PDU) having a magnetic hold brake for use in an aircraft is disclosed herein. The PDU includes a wheel configured to convey cargo through a portion of the aircraft, a motor coupled to the wheel, a brake disk, a solenoid configured to apply a first force to move the brake disk in a first direction to resist rotation of the motor, wherein the solenoid is further configured to apply a second force to move the brake disk in a second direction opposite the first direction to allow the motor to rotate, and a magnet configured to apply a third force to the brake disk, the third force being in the first direction to apply a drag force to the motor.

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Background/Summary

FIELD

(1) The present disclosure generally relates cargo loading systems for aircraft and, more specifically, to a power drive unit designed to provide a magnetic hold braking function.

BACKGROUND

(2) Aircraft may transport at least one of passengers or cargo. Many aircraft thus have at least one cargo bay designed to receive cargo. Such cargo bays include cargo loading systems that include rollers located on a floor of the cargo bay along with power drive units (PDUs) that provide propulsion to drive a unit load device (ULD, cargo) through the cargo bay. Occasionally, power may be disturbed during loading of a cargo bay. In such situations, the PDU may either operate in a fully braked state in which the ULD cannot be manually pushed off the PDU or an open state in which the ULD may freely roll across the PDU or in a drag state where a ULD may be manually pushed over the PDU.

SUMMARY

(3) A power drive unit (PDU) having a magnetic hold brake for use in an aircraft is disclosed herein. The PDU includes a wheel configured to convey cargo through a portion of the aircraft, a motor coupled to the wheel, a brake disk, a solenoid configured to apply a first force to move the brake disk in a first direction to resist rotation of the motor, wherein the solenoid is further configured to apply a second force to move the brake disk in a second direction opposite the first direction to allow the motor to rotate, and a magnet configured to apply a third force to the brake disk, the third force being in the first direction to apply a drag force to the motor.

(4) In various embodiments, the solenoid applies the first force in response to a first current having a first polarity and wherein the solenoid applies the second force in response to a second current having a second polarity that is opposite the first polarity. In various embodiments, the PDU further includes a spring configured to apply a fourth force to the brake disk, the fourth force being in the second direction, wherein the spring assists the solenoid in moving the brake disk in the second direction. In various embodiments, the solenoid is positioned about an axis of rotation of the motor and the spring is located radially inward from the solenoid.

(5) In various embodiments, the PDU further includes a motor shaft coupled to the motor and the wheel to transfer torque from the motor to the wheel, wherein the motor shaft is further coupled to the brake disk. In various embodiments, the solenoid is positioned about an axis of rotation of the motor shaft. In various embodiments, the drag force is sufficient to resist rotation of the motor shaft. In various embodiments, the solenoid further includes a solenoid coil and a solenoid housing, the solenoid coil being located in the solenoid housing. In various embodiments, the magnet is disposed around an outer circumference of the solenoid.

(6) Also disclosed herein is a magnetic hold brake. The magnetic hold brake includes a brake housing, a brake disk, a solenoid disposed within the brake housing, the solenoid configured to apply a first force to move the brake disk in a first direction to a first position, and a magnet configured to apply a second force to the brake disk to hold the brake disk in the first position.

(7) In various embodiments, the solenoid is configured to apply the first force in response to a first current having a first polarity. In various embodiments, the solenoid is configured to apply a third force allowing the brake disk to move in a second direction to a second position in response to a second current having a second polarity that is opposite the first polarity, the second direction being opposite the first direction. In various embodiments, the magnetic hold brake further includes a hole extending through the solenoid, the brake housing, and the brake disk, and a spring a spring disposed within the hole and configured to apply a fourth force to move the brake disk in the second direction to a third position.

(8) In various embodiments, the solenoid further includes a solenoid coil and a solenoid housing, the solenoid coil and the spring being disposed within the solenoid housing. In various embodiments, the hole is configured to receive a motor shaft of a motor and the magnetic hold

brake is configured to resist rotation of the motor shaft. In various embodiments, the magnet is disposed around an outer circumference of the solenoid.

(9) Also disclosed herein is a power drive unit (PDU) having a magnetic hold brake for use in an aircraft. The PDU includes a wheel configured to convey cargo through a portion of the aircraft, a motor configured to generate torque, a gearbox coupled to the wheel, a motor shaft coupled to the motor and the gear box to transfer torque from the motor to the gearbox, a brake disk, a solenoid coupled to the motor shaft and the brake disk and configured to apply a first force to move the brake disk in a first direction to a braking position in response to a first condition, a spring disposed in the solenoid and configured to apply a second force in a second direction to the brake disk, the second direction being opposite the first direction, and a magnet disposed around the solenoid and configured to apply a third force in the first direction to the brake disk.

(10) In various embodiments, the first condition is a first electric current having a first polarity. In various embodiments, the solenoid is further configured to apply a fourth force to move the brake disk in the second direction in response a second electric current having a second polarity, the second polarity being opposite the first polarity. In various embodiments, the first force moves the brake disk to a first position and wherein the third force is sufficient to hold the brake disk in the first position.

(11) The foregoing features and elements may be combined in any combination, without exclusivity, unless expressly indicated herein otherwise. These features and elements as well as the operation of the disclosed embodiments will become more apparent in light of the following description and accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The subject matter of the present disclosure is particularly pointed out and distinctly claimed in the concluding portion of the specification. A more complete understanding of the present disclosure, however, may best be obtained by referring to the following detailed description and claims in connection with the following drawings. While the drawings illustrate various embodiments employing the principles described herein, the drawings do not limit the scope of the claims.

(2) FIGS. 1A and 1B illustrate a schematic of an aircraft being loaded and a portion of a cargo handling system, in accordance with various embodiments.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a portion of a cargo handling system, in accordance with various embodiments.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates a power drive unit, in accordance with various embodiments.

(5) FIGS. 4A, 4B, and 4C illustrate a magnetic hold brake unit, in accordance with various embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(6) The following detailed description of various embodiments herein makes reference to the accompanying drawings, which show various embodiments by way of illustration. While these various embodiments are described in sufficient detail to enable those skilled in the art to practice the disclosure, it should be understood that other embodiments may be realized and that changes may be made without departing from the scope of the disclosure. Thus, the detailed description herein is presented for purposes of illustration only and not of limitation. Furthermore, any reference to singular includes plural embodiments, and any reference to more than one component or step may include a singular embodiment or step. Also, any reference to attached, fixed, connected, or the like may include permanent, removable, temporary, partial, full or any other possible attachment option. Additionally, any reference to without contact (or similar phrases) may

also include reduced contact or minimal contact. It should also be understood that unless specifically stated otherwise, references to “a,” “an” or “the” may include one or more than one and that reference to an item in the singular may also include the item in the plural. Further, all ranges may include upper and lower values and all ranges and ratio limits disclosed herein may be combined.

(7) Disclosed herein is a power drive unit (PDU) for use in a cargo hold area. The PDU includes one or more tires, a motor, and a magnetic hold brake. In various embodiments, the one or more tires are coupled to the motor, such as by a motor shaft of the motor, and provide motive force for moving cargo (e.g., unit load devices (ULD)) within the cargo hold area. In various embodiments, the magnetic hold brake is connected to the motor (e.g., connected to the motor shaft) and provides a braking force for the motor and the one or more tires. In various embodiments, the magnetic hold brake includes three states: brake applied, magnetic lock, and brake released. The braking functionality of the PDU may provide protection for the cargo area, the cargo, and workers from impacts during loading and unloading operations.

(8) The magnetic hold brake includes a solenoid, an optional spring, and a magnet. In various embodiments, each of the solenoid, the optional spring, and the magnet may be disposed around the motor shaft of the PDU motor. In various embodiments, the magnetic hold brake may be connected to a disk brake and further include a friction material located between the disk brake and the solenoid, the optional spring, and the magnet. In various embodiments, the optional spring may be biased to push the brake disk away from the friction material, allowing the motor shaft, and by extension the one or more tires, to rotate with little to no braking.

(9) In various embodiments, the magnetic hold brake includes a first state, a second state, and a third state. The first state may be a brake applied state, the second state may be a magnetic lock state, and the third state may be a brake release state. In various embodiments, in the first state, an electric current having a first polarity is applied to the solenoid to activate the solenoid. The solenoid generates a magnetic flux in response to the being activated and the magnetic flux attracts the disk brake to the solenoid. In various embodiments, this provides a braking force as the disk brake is pulled (e.g., forced) against the friction material.

(10) In various embodiments, in the second state, the electric current is removed from the solenoid, deactivating the solenoid. The magnet holds the disk brake against the friction material, providing a braking force. In various embodiments, the braking force of the second state is less than the braking force of the first state. In various embodiments, this may allow the one or more tires to rotate, allowing cargo to be moved manually, when there is no power provided to the PDU. In various embodiments, the force used to rotate the one or more tires in the second state may be greater than the force used to rotate the one or more tires in the third state. In various embodiments, the magnetic lock of the magnetic hold brake provides similar functionality to currently used braking rollers, allowing for the removal of braking rollers from the cargo area.

(11) In various embodiments, in the third state, an electric current having a second polarity that is opposite the first polarity is applied to the solenoid to activate the solenoid. The solenoid generates a magnetic flux in response to being activated and the magnetic flux of the solenoid counterbalances the magnet (e.g., zero flux) to reduce the force on the friction material. This allows the motor shaft and the one or more tires to rotate with little to no braking force. In various embodiments, the optional spring may be used to completely release the brake disk from the friction material.

(12) As can be seen, the magnetic hold brake as disclosed herein may provide improved braking and control of the PDU and the cargo being moved by the PDU. Furthermore, the magnetic hold brake as disclosed herein may reduce the number of parts used in the cargo area (e.g., remove braking rollers) as well as the number of parts used in the PDU brake. This may result in a cost, weight, and reliability savings.

(13) Referring now to FIG. 1A, a schematic view of an aircraft **10** having a cargo deck **12** located

within a cargo compartment **14** is illustrated, in accordance with various embodiments. The aircraft **10** may comprise a cargo load door **16** located, for example, at one side of a fuselage structure of the aircraft **10**. A unit load device (ULD) **20**, in the form of a container or pallet, for example, may be loaded through the cargo load door **16** and onto the cargo deck **12** of the aircraft **10** or, conversely, unloaded from the cargo deck **12** of the aircraft **10**. In general, ULDs are available in various sizes and capacities, and are typically standardized in dimension and shape. Once loaded with items destined for shipment, the ULD **20** is transferred to the aircraft **10** and then loaded onto the aircraft **10** through the cargo load door **16** using a conveyor ramp, scissor lift or the like. Once inside the aircraft **10**, the ULD **20** is moved within the cargo compartment **14** to a final stowed position. Multiple ULDs may be brought on-board the aircraft **10**, with each ULD **20** being placed in a respective stowed position on the cargo deck **12**. After the aircraft **10** has reached its destination, each ULD **20** is unloaded from the aircraft **10** in similar fashion, but in reverse sequence to the loading procedure. To facilitate movement of the ULD **20** along the cargo deck **12**, the aircraft **10** may include a cargo handling system as described herein in accordance with various embodiments.

(14) Referring now to FIG. **1B**, a portion of a cargo handling system **100** is illustrated, in accordance with various embodiments. The cargo handling system **100** is illustrated with reference to an XYZ coordinate system, with the X-direction extending longitudinally and the Z-direction extending vertically with respect to an aircraft in which the cargo handling system **100** is positioned, such as, for example, the aircraft **10** described above with reference to FIG. **1A**. In various embodiments, the cargo handling system **100** may define a conveyance surface **102** having a plurality of trays **104** supported by a cargo deck **112**, such as, for example, the cargo deck **12** described above with reference to FIG. **1A**. The plurality of trays **104** may be configured to support a unit load device (ULD) **120** (or a plurality of ULDs), such as, for example, the unit load device (ULD) **20** described above with reference to FIG. **1A**. In various embodiments, the ULD **120** may comprise a container or a pallet configured to hold cargo as described above. In various embodiments, the plurality of trays **104** is disposed throughout the cargo deck **112** and may support a plurality of conveyance rollers **106**, where one or more or all of the plurality of conveyance rollers **106** is a passive roller.

(15) In various embodiments, the plurality of trays **104** may further support a plurality of power drive units (PDUs) **110**, each of which may include one or more drive wheels or rollers **108** that may be actively powered by a motor. In various embodiments, one or more of the plurality of trays **104** is positioned longitudinally along the cargo deck **112**—e.g., along the X-direction extending from the forward end to the aft end of the aircraft. In various embodiments, the plurality of conveyance rollers **106** and the one or more drive rollers **108** may be configured to facilitate transport of the ULD **120** in the forward and the aft directions along the conveyance surface **102**. During loading and unloading, the ULD **120** may variously contact the one or more drive rollers **108** to provide a motive force for transporting the ULD **120** along the conveyance surface **102**. Each of the plurality of PDUs **110** may include an actuator, such as, for example, an electrically operated motor, configured to drive the one or more drive rollers **108** corresponding with each such PDU **110**. In various embodiments, the one or more drive rollers **108** may be raised from a lowered position beneath the conveyance surface **102** to an elevated position protruding above the conveyance surface **102** by the corresponding PDU. As used with respect to cargo handling system **100**, the term “beneath” may refer to the negative Z-direction, and the term “above” may refer to the positive Z-direction with respect to the conveyance surface **102**. In the elevated position, the one or more drive rollers **108** variously contact and drive the ULD **120** that otherwise rides on the plurality of conveyance rollers **106**. Other types of PDUs, which can also be used in various embodiments of the present disclosure, may include a drive roller that is held or biased in a position above the conveyance surface by a spring. PDUs as disclosed herein may be any type of electrically powered rollers that may be selectively energized to propel or drive the ULD **120** in a

desired direction over the cargo deck **112** of the aircraft. The plurality of trays **104** may further support a plurality of restraint devices **114**. In various embodiments, each of the plurality of restraint devices **114** may be configured to rotate downward as the ULD **120** passes over and along the conveyance surface **102**. Once the ULD **120** passes over any such one of the plurality of restraint devices **114**, such restraint device **114** returns to its upright position, either by manual intervention, a motor driven actuator, or a bias member, thereby restraining or preventing the ULD **120** from translating in the opposite direction.

(16) Referring now to FIG. 2, a PDU **210**, such as for example, one of the plurality of PDUs **110** described above with reference to FIG. 1B, is illustrated disposed in a tray **204**, in accordance with various embodiments. The PDU **210** may rotate the drive roller **208** in one of two possible directions (e.g., clockwise or counterclockwise) to propel the ULD in a direction parallel to the longitudinal axis B-B' of the tray **204**. The PDU **210** may comprise a unit controller **240**, a unit motor **242** and a drive roller **208** mounted within an interior section **205** of the tray **204**. The drive roller **208** may comprise a cylindrical wheel coupled to a drive shaft and configured to rotate about an axis A-A'. The drive roller **208** may be in mechanical communication with the unit motor **242**, which may be, for example, an electromagnetic, electromechanical or electrohydraulic actuator or other servomechanism. The PDU **210** may further include gear assemblies and other related components for turning or raising the drive roller **208** so that the drive roller **208** may extend, at least partially, above a conveyance surface **202** which, in various embodiments, may be defined as the uppermost surface **203** (e.g., in the z-direction) of the tray **204**. At least partial extension of the drive roller **208** above the conveyance surface **202** facilitates contact between the drive roller **208** and a lower surface of a ULD, such as, for example, the ULD **120** described above with reference to FIG. 1B. In various embodiments, the unit controller **240** is configured to control operation of the drive roller **208**. The unit controller **240** may include a processor and a tangible, non-transitory memory. The processor may comprise one or more logic modules that implement logic to control rotation and elevation of the drive roller **208**. In various embodiments, the PDU **210** may comprise other electrical devices to implement drive logic. In various embodiments, a connector **244** is used to couple the electronics of the PDU **210** to a power source and a system controller, such as, for example, the system controller **130** described above with reference to FIG. 1B. The connector **244** may have pins or slots and may be configured to couple to a wiring harness having pin programming. The unit controller **240** may be configured to receive commands from the system controller through the connector **244** in order to control operation of the unit motor **242**.

(17) In various embodiments, the PDU **210** may also include a radio frequency identification device or RFID device **246**, or similar device, configured to store, transmit or receive information or data—e.g., operational status or location data. Additionally, a ULD sensor **219** may be disposed within the tray **204** and configured to detect the presence of a ULD as the ULD is positioned over or proximate to the PDU **210** or the restraint device **214**. In various embodiments, the ULD sensor **219** may include any type of sensor capable of detecting the presence of a ULD. For example, in various embodiments, the ULD sensor **219** may comprise a proximity sensor, a capacitive sensor, a capacitive displacement sensor, a Doppler effect sensor, an eddy-current sensor, a laser rangefinder sensor, a magnetic sensor, an active or passive optical sensor, an active or passive thermal sensor, a photocell sensor, a radar sensor, a sonar sensor, a lidar sensor, an ultrasonic sensor or the like.

(18) Referring now to FIG. 3, in accordance with various embodiments, a perspective view of components of a power drive unit (PDU) **300** is illustrated. PDU **300** includes tires **302**, lift springs **304**, a gearbox **306**, and a motor assembly **308**. Tires **302** are configured to engage cargo (e.g., ULD **120**) to move the cargo (e.g., along the y-axis). Lift spring **304** are configured to aid in raising and lower PDU **300** (e.g., in the z-axis) so that tires **302** are able to engage the cargo (e.g., in a raised position) and disengage from the cargo (e.g., in a lowered position). Gearbox **306** includes one or more gears that transfer rotational movement from motor assembly **308** to tires **302** for moving the cargo.

(19) Motor assembly **308** includes a motor **310**, a motor shaft **312**, one or more stators **314**, one or more rotors **316**, and a brake assembly **318**. At least one of stator **314** or rotor **316** may include at least one magnet, and at least one of stator **314** or rotor **316** may include coils, or windings. In response to electricity being applied to stator **314** or rotor **316**, a magnetic flux may be generated which causes the rotor **316** to rotate relative to the stator **314**, thus generating torque. Motor shaft **312** may be rotatably coupled to rotor **316** and may rotate along with rotor **316**. The torque generated by motor **310** may be transferred to motor shaft **312**. Motor shaft **312** may be coupled to gearbox **306** that is configured to transfer rotational movement from motor shaft **312** to tires **302**.

(20) Brake assembly **318** includes a brake disk **320**, an optional spring **322**, a friction material **324**, a solenoid **326**, and a magnet **328**. Solenoid **326** may include a solenoid coil **330** and a solenoid housing **332**. In various embodiments, solenoid **326** may be located around an axis of rotation of motor shaft **312**. Brake assembly **318** may function to hold PDU **300** in a brake position. More specifically, brake assembly **318** may function to hold tires **302** in a brake position, preventing rotation of tires **302**.

(21) In a first state, solenoid **326** activates brake disk **320** thereby applying a braking force to motor shaft **312**, and by extension, tires **302**. That is, in response to solenoid **326** being activated by a first polarity, a first magnetic flux may be generated in solenoid coil **330** which causes brake disk **320** to move toward solenoid **326** (e.g., in the negative x-direction), contacting friction material **324**, and slowing the rotation of motor shaft **312**.

(22) In a second state, solenoid **326** is deactivated brake disk **320** is magnetically latched to brake assembly **318**, and more specifically, to magnet **328**. That is, in response to solenoid **326** being deactivated, brake disk **320** remains in contact with friction material **324** by magnetic force of magnet **328**. The second state maintains a braking force on motor shaft **312**, and thereby on tires **302**, when power is removed from PDU **300**. In various embodiments, the braking force of the second state is less than the braking force of the first state. In various embodiments, magnet **328** is a permanent magnet.

(23) In a third state, solenoid **326** overcomes the magnetic force on brake disk **320** thereby releasing the braking force from motor shaft **312**, and by extension, tires **302**. That is, in response to solenoid **326** being activated by a second polarity that is opposite the first polarity, a second magnetic flux may be generated in solenoid coil **330** which cancels out magnetic attraction of powered off solenoid **326** on brake disk **320** allowing brake disk **320** to move away from solenoid **326** (e.g., in the x-direction) and further allowing motor shaft **312** to rotate. In various embodiments, optional spring **322** may assist solenoid **326** by repelling brake disk **320** to disengage brake disk **320** entirely from friction material **324**.

(24) Referring now to FIGS. **4A-4C**, in accordance with various embodiments, a magnetic hold brake **400** is illustrated. FIG. **4A** illustrates a perspective view of magnetic hold brake **400**. FIG. **4B** illustrates a cross section view of magnetic hold brake **400** in a released position. FIG. **4C** illustrates a cross section view of magnetic hold brake **400** in a braking position. Magnetic hold brake **400** includes a brake body **402**, wires **404**, mount holes **406**, and a hole **408** for receiving motor shaft **312**. Hole **408** includes a flat key **408a** and a flat key **408b** for engaging motor shaft **312** to prevent rotation of motor shaft **312** when a braking force is applied. In various embodiments, hole **408** may be circular, oval, square, or hexagonal, among other shapes. Mount holes **406** provide a secure location for mounting magnetic hold brake **400** in a power drive unit (PDU). In various embodiments, magnetic hold brake **400** may be a drop-in replacement for a brake system currently used in a PDU. Wires **404** provide an electric path for activating magnetic hold brake **400**.

(25) Magnetic hold brake **400** further includes a brake disk **420**, an optional spring **422**, a friction material **424**, a solenoid **426**, and a magnet **428**. Solenoid **426** further includes solenoid coils **430** and a solenoid housing **432** where solenoid coils **430** are located in solenoid housing **432**. In various embodiments, the components of magnetic hold brake **400** may be similar to the

components of brake assembly **318**. As illustrated in FIGS. **4B** and **4C**, hole **408** further extends through brake disk **420**, optional spring **422**, and solenoid **426**. In various embodiments, optional spring **422** is biased to apply a force to move brake disk **420** away from solenoid **426** (e.g., in the x-direction). Brake disk **420** may be separated from friction material **424** by a distance d_1 , as illustrated in FIG. **4B**. Distance d_1 may be about 50 μm to about 250 μm , and more specifically, about 100 μm to about 200 μm . As illustrated in FIG. **4B**, magnetic hold brake **400**, and more specifically, brake disk **420**, does not apply a braking force, allowing a motor shaft (e.g., motor shaft **312**) to rotate.

(26) Wires **404** provide electric current to solenoid **426**. Solenoid **426** generates a first magnetic flux in response to a first current having a first polarity. The first magnetic flux attracts brake disk **420** to solenoid **426** (e.g., the negative x-direction) so that brake disk **420** contacts and engages friction material **424**. That is, solenoid **426** applies a force (e.g., in the negative x-direction) to move brake disk **420** in a first direction to a braking position. This causes magnetic hold brake **400** to apply a braking force to the motor shaft, arresting rotation of the motor shaft and by extensions the tires **302** of PDU **300**, for example. In various embodiments, the first current may be applied to solenoid **426** for a first period of time that is sufficient to stop the rotation of tires **302** and then may be removed. In various embodiments, the first period of time may be about 0.25 seconds to about 2 seconds, and more specifically about 0.75 seconds to about 1.5 seconds. In various embodiment, the first current may be applied to solenoid **426** indefinitely to prevent tires **302** from rotating.

(27) In various embodiments, after the first period of time, the first current is removed from solenoid **426**. The magnet flux generated by solenoid **426** stops in response to the first current being removed. Magnet **428** applies a sufficient force (e.g., in the negative-x direction) to hold brake disk **420** in the braking position. The force applied by magnet **428** (e.g., in the negative x-direction) is greater than the force applied by optional spring **422** (e.g., in the x-direction) but may be less than the force applied by activated solenoid **426** (e.g., in the negative x-direction). In this state, magnetic hold brake **400** operates in a drag mode which requires more force to rotate tires **302** than when tires **302** are freely rotating but less force than when a full braking force is applied. In various embodiments, magnet **428** is located around an outer circumference of solenoid **426**. In various embodiments magnet **428** is chosen to be to apply a magnetic latching force strong enough to hold brake disk **420** is in the braking positing but not so strong that magnet **428** is able to move brake disk **420** to the braking position without solenoid **426**. In various embodiments, magnet **428** may be moved axially (e.g., in the x-axis) closer to brake disk **420** or further away from brake disk **420** than is illustrated in FIGS. **4B** and **4C**. In various embodiments, magnet **428** is a permanent magnet.

(28) Solenoid **426** generates a second magnetic flux that is opposite the first magnetic flux in response to a second current having a second polarity that is opposite the first polarity. The second magnetic flux overcomes the magnetic flux of magnet brake disk **420** away from solenoid **426** (e.g., in the x-direction). That is, solenoid **426** applies a force (e.g., in the x-direction) to move brake disk **420** in a second direction to a rotating position. In various embodiments, optional spring **422** assists in repelling brake disk **420**. While in the rotating position, motor shaft **312** and tires **302** may rotate with little to no braking force.

(29) As described herein, magnetic hold brake **400** has three states of operation. In a first state of operation, brake disk **420** is electrically applied using solenoid **426** and magnetic hold brake **400** resists rotation of motor shaft **312**. In a second state, brake disk **420** is magnetically latched by magnet **428** and magnetic hold brake **400** resists rotation of motor shaft **312**. Magnetic hold brake **400** provides less resistance in the second state than in the first state. In a third state, brake disk **420** is electrically released using solenoid **426** and optional spring **422** and magnetic hold brake **400** allows motor shaft **312** to rotate.

(30) Benefits, other advantages, and solutions to problems have been described herein with regard to specific embodiments. Furthermore, the connecting lines shown in the various figures contained

herein are intended to represent exemplary functional relationships and/or physical couplings between the various elements. It should be noted that many alternative or additional functional relationships or physical connections may be present in a practical system. However, the benefits, advantages, solutions to problems, and any elements that may cause any benefit, advantage, or solution to occur or become more pronounced are not to be construed as critical, required, or essential features or elements of the disclosure. The scope of the disclosure is accordingly to be limited by nothing other than the appended claims, in which reference to an element in the singular is not intended to mean “one and only one” unless explicitly so stated, but rather “one or more.” Moreover, where a phrase similar to “at least one of A, B, or C” is used in the claims, it is intended that the phrase be interpreted to mean that A alone may be present in an embodiment, B alone may be present in an embodiment, C alone may be present in an embodiment, or that any combination of the elements A, B and C may be present in a single embodiment; for example, A and B, A and C, B and C, or A and B and C. Different cross-hatching is used throughout the figures to denote different parts but not necessarily to denote the same or different materials.

(31) Systems, methods and apparatus are provided herein. In the detailed description herein, references to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “various embodiments,” etc., indicate that the embodiment described may include a particular feature, structure, or characteristic, but every embodiment may not necessarily include the particular feature, structure, or characteristic. Moreover, such phrases are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment. Further, when a particular feature, structure, or characteristic is described in connection with an embodiment, it is submitted that it is within the knowledge of one skilled in the art to affect such feature, structure, or characteristic in connection with other embodiments whether or not explicitly described. After reading the description, it will be apparent to one skilled in the relevant art(s) how to implement the disclosure in alternative embodiments.

(32) Numbers, percentages, or other values stated herein are intended to include that value, and also other values that are about or approximately equal to the stated value, as would be appreciated by one of ordinary skill in the art encompassed by various embodiments of the present disclosure. A stated value should therefore be interpreted broadly enough to encompass values that are at least close enough to the stated value to perform a desired function or achieve a desired result. The stated values include at least the variation to be expected in a suitable industrial process, and may include values that are within 10%, within 5%, within 1%, within 0.1%, or within 0.01% of a stated value. Additionally, the terms “substantially,” “about” or “approximately” as used herein represent an amount close to the stated amount that still performs a desired function or achieves a desired result. For example, the term “substantially,” “about” or “approximately” may refer to an amount that is within 10% of, within 5% of, within 1% of, within 0.1% of, and within 0.01% of a stated amount or value.

(33) Furthermore, no element, component, or method step in the present disclosure is intended to be dedicated to the public regardless of whether the element, component, or method step is explicitly recited in the claims. No claim element herein is to be construed under the provisions of 35 U.S.C. 112(f) unless the element is expressly recited using the phrase “means for.” As used herein, the terms “comprises,” “comprising,” or any other variation thereof, are intended to cover a non-exclusive inclusion, such that a process, method, article, or apparatus that comprises a list of elements does not include only those elements but may include other elements not expressly listed or inherent to such process, method, article, or apparatus.

(34) Finally, it should be understood that any of the above described concepts can be used alone or in combination with any or all of the other above described concepts. Although various embodiments have been disclosed and described, one of ordinary skill in this art would recognize that certain modifications would come within the scope of this disclosure. Accordingly, the description is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the principles described or illustrated herein to any precise form. Many modifications and variations are possible in light of the above teaching.

Claims

1. A power drive unit (PDU) having a magnetic hold brake for use in an aircraft, the PDU comprising: a wheel configured to convey cargo through a portion of the aircraft; a motor coupled to the wheel; a brake disk; a solenoid configured to apply a first force on the brake disk to move the brake disk in a first direction to resist rotation of the motor, wherein the solenoid is further configured to apply a second force on the brake disk to move the brake disk in a second direction opposite the first direction to allow the motor to rotate, wherein the solenoid applies the first force in response to a first current having a first polarity and wherein the solenoid applies the second force in response to a second current having a second polarity that is opposite the first polarity; and a magnet having the first polarity and configured to apply a third force on the brake disk, the third force being in the first direction to apply a drag force to the motor.
2. The PDU of claim 1, further comprising: a spring configured to apply a fourth force to the brake disk, the fourth force being in the second direction, wherein the spring assists the solenoid in moving the brake disk in the second direction, and wherein, in response to the solenoid applying neither the first force nor the second force, the third force overcomes the fourth force.
3. The PDU of claim 2, wherein the solenoid is positioned about an axis of rotation of the motor and the spring is located radially inward from the solenoid.
4. The PDU of claim 1, further comprising: a motor shaft coupled to the motor and the wheel to transfer torque from the motor to the wheel, wherein the motor shaft is further coupled to the brake disk.
5. The PDU of claim 4, wherein the solenoid is positioned about an axis of rotation of the motor shaft.
6. The PDU of claim 4, wherein the drag force is sufficient to resist rotation of the motor shaft.
7. The PDU of claim 1, wherein the solenoid further includes a solenoid coil and a solenoid housing, the solenoid coil being located in the solenoid housing.
8. The PDU of claim 1, wherein the magnet is disposed around an outer circumference of the solenoid.
9. A magnetic hold brake, comprising: a brake housing; a brake disk; a solenoid disposed within the brake housing, the solenoid configured to apply a first force on the brake disk to move the brake disk in a first direction to a first position in response to a first current having a first polarity, the first position being a braking position; and a magnet having the first polarity and configured to apply a second force on the brake disk to hold the brake disk in the first position, wherein the solenoid is configured to apply a third force on the brake disk allowing the brake disk to move in a second direction to a second position in response to a second current having a second polarity that is opposite the first polarity, the second direction being opposite the first direction.
10. The magnetic hold brake of claim 9, further comprising: a hole extending through the solenoid, the brake housing, and the brake disk; and a spring disposed within the hole and configured to apply a fourth force to move the brake disk in the second direction to a third position.
11. The magnetic hold brake of claim 10, wherein the solenoid further includes a solenoid coil and a solenoid housing, the solenoid coil and the spring being disposed within the solenoid housing.
12. The magnetic hold brake of claim 10, wherein the hole is configured to receive a motor shaft of a motor and the magnetic hold brake is configured to resist rotation of the motor shaft.
13. The magnetic hold brake of claim 9, wherein the magnet is disposed around an outer circumference of the solenoid.
14. A power drive unit (PDU) having a magnetic hold brake for use in an aircraft, the PDU comprising: a wheel configured to convey cargo through a portion of the aircraft; a motor configured to generate torque; a gearbox coupled to the wheel; a motor shaft coupled to the motor and the gear box to transfer torque from the motor to the gearbox; a brake disk; a solenoid coupled

to the motor shaft and the brake disk and configured to apply a first force on the brake disk to move the brake disk in a first direction to a braking position in response to a first electric current having a first polarity; a spring disposed in the solenoid and configured to apply a second force in a second direction on the brake disk, the second direction being opposite the first direction; and a magnet having the first polarity and disposed around the solenoid and configured to apply a third force in the first direction on the brake disk.

15. The PDU of claim 14, wherein the solenoid is further configured to apply a fourth force to move the brake disk in the second direction in response to a second electric current having a second polarity, the second polarity being opposite the first polarity.

16. The PDU of claim 15, wherein the first force moves the brake disk to a first position and wherein the third force is sufficient to hold the brake disk in the first position in response to the solenoid applying neither the first force nor the fourth force.
